

How to protect yourself from unsolicited calls or messages?

There are steps you can take to reduce or stop UCC or spam. You can also make a complaint or report spam to your service providers.

Tips Customers

Measures to be taken to avoid UCC

- don't tick subscribe boxes when completing online forms
- don't provide mobile number to potential spamming source
- Register your preference to manage who can send commercial communication to you. Learn more on how to modify preference
- Manage consent given to entities who are sending commercial communication. Learn more on how to revoke consent

1. Think before making your number public:

You may also get irrelevant messages or calls if you make your phone number public. If you don't want to receive such messages, you should write that with the number.

If a sender breaks the UCC or spam rules, you can complain or report

2. Find out who sent you the SMS or made a call on your mobile:

You can enquire about the sending party information by typing the header details. For more information please visit Header Information Portal

3. SMS/Calls you might receive:

- Transactional messages/calls
- Service messages/calls
- Government awareness messages/calls
- Alerts/messages from Telecom Service Provider

Customer Preference Registration Facility

Register your preference to manage who can send commercial communication to you.

1. Preference Choices Includes:-

- Categories of Commercial Communication
  - Mode(s) of communication
  - Time Band(s)
  - Types of Day(s) of the week including public and national holiday(s)

2. Modes to register, modify or de-register your preference(s) includes

- Sending SMS to short code 1909; or
- Calling on 1909; or
- Interactive Voice Response System (IVRS); or

- Mobile app developed in this regard either by the Authority or by any other person or entity and
- Approved by the Authority; or
- Web portal with authentication through OTP; or
- Any other means as may be prescribed by the Authority from time to time.

#### Code of Practice for preference and revocation of Consent.

Code of practice for preference and revocation of consent (COP-Preference) to be developed by TSPs with reference to Schedule -II of TCCCPR, 2018.

Every TSP is required to comply with the submitted COPs, provided that any provision in Code(s) of Practice shall not have effect to the extent of being inconsistent with the regulations.

[Links](#) of TSPs' websites for COP-Preference

#### How can you register or modify your preference?

Check [modes](#) to register, modify or de-register your preference. For more details visit [TSP websites](#).

#### What is consent?

Consent means any voluntary permission given by the customer to the sender to receive commercial communication related to specific purpose, product or service.

#### Who can give consent and to whom?

As per new regulatory framework TSPs are responsible to maintain digital records of consent given by customers to principal entities (business and legal entities) in a robust and verifiable manner.

A mobile subscriber/recipient of commercial communication gives consent to principal entities which digitally records using the consent acquisition process developed by collaboration of principal entities and TSPs.

#### How to manage consent?

You can manage your consent given to the sender for sending commercial communication to you. For more information on how to revoke consent, visit TSPs' [Website](#)

#### Complain or report against UCC:

If you think the message or call received is UCC or spam, you can complain or report it to your Telecom Service Provider (TSP).

This won't stop all messages but it may allow TSP to take action.

There is a difference between making a complaint and reporting UCC or spam.

Difference between making a complaint and reporting UCC or spam:

Any complaint made within 3 days from the date of UCC/Spam are considered valid complaints. These complaints are entitled for further investigation and may lead to action against senders. Ex. You receive UCC/Spam on 15/04/2021 so you must complain before 18/04/2021.

But complaints made beyond 3 days are considered Reports. These reports would not lead to action against the sender at first hand but would aid in finding such spammers proactively.

Make a complaint or report about UCC or spam:

When you make a complaint, TSP will ask you for:

- • Mode of communication
- • Details of sender
- • Date and Time of message or call
- • Category of commercial communication
- • Description of message or call

After you make a complaint or report:

Your TSP will share a complaint ID through which you can track your complaint or report and actions taken against it.

Modes to register complaint or report:

- • sending SMS to short code 1909; or
- • calling on 1909; or
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- • Mobile app developed in this regard either by the Authority or by any other person or entity and approved by the Authority; or
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- • Any other means as may be notified by the Authority from time to time

When you report UCC or spam, TSP does not register this as a complaint. It is a quick way to give TSPs information about UCC or spam activity so they can identify spam trends and potential compliance issues.

#### Code of Practice - Complaint handling:

Code of practice for Complaint (COP-Complaint) to be developed by TSPs with reference to Schedule -III of TCCCPR, 2018.

Every TSP is required to comply with the submitted COPs, provided that any provision in Code(s) of Practice shall not have effect to the extent of being inconsistent with the regulations.

[Links](#) of TSPs' websites for COP-Complaint

Find out who sent you the SMS:

The Header Information Portal facilitates Customers to know the sender of Commercial and Government awareness communications.

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Header Information [Portal link](#)